



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Coram Deo Academies

School Website: <https://www.coramdeoacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Coram Deo Academy (CDA) presents a robust Classical Christian educational model that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements framework. The public-facing materials portray CDA as Christian, Classical, and Collaborative, with a clear aim toward forming virtuous, wise students who pursue Truth, Goodness, and Beauty within a theology-integrated curriculum and a foundation of communal worship, parent partnership, and Socratic- and rhetoric-infused pedagogy. Across campus pages and program descriptions, CDA emphasizes a Great-Books–style, liberal-arts-informed curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; great works), a pedagogy featuring memory work, recitation, narration, Socratic discussion, and public speaking, and a family- and church-aligned community model that treats parents as co-educators. This combination supports a CLASSICAL overall rating across all six categories, with evidence of explicit classical signals (theology-integrated education, Great Books orientation, Socratic and rhetoric pedagogy, and a living-curriculum faculty/community ideal) and minimal indicators of non-classical signals in the public materials.

Key insights:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strongly present: explicit Christian framing, theology woven through academics, chapel/fellowship language, and an orthodox theological stance. This maps closely to the Positive Keywords around theology, liturgical practice, and sacred formation in the Six Essential Elements corpus.
- Purpose and Goal: CDA's mission centers on forming virtuous servant-leaders and wise thinkers under a Christ-centered framework, emphasizing formation over mere information and the pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty. This aligns with the Classical rubric's telos and formation signals.
- Curriculum is clearly liberal-arts–leaning and connected to Great Books/Great Conversation (even if the exact phrase "Great Books" is not always explicit on every page, the site emphasizes great works, classical curriculum, Latin, and historical-literary engagement). This matches the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books/-Great Conversation signals and the "formation through the arts" orientation in the knowledge-base rubric.
- Pedagogy features Socratic discussion in upper grades, rhetoric and public speaking, and memory work in earlier years, with lower grades incorporating singing/chanting and memory-rich routines. This mirrors the Classical pedagogy signals in the rubric.
- Faculty ideal: teachers described as virtuous, living curriculum, mentors, and partners with families; a culture of collaboration and discipleship is foregrounded.
- Parents & Community: CDA's Collaborative Model and parent-in-home-learning emphasis position parents as co-teachers, with open-campus/semi-structured parent engagement, evidencing strong partnership with families.

Overall aggregate rating: CLASSICAL

Note on needle-moving: No major structural changes are required to reach full CLASSICAL status; the materials already hit core signals across all six categories. If anything were pursued to push toward a more explicit "Great Conversation/Great Books" phrasing across all program descriptions, and a slightly more explicit articulation of classical vocabulary (e.g., consistent use of "Great Books" and "Solemn rites of liturgy" language in every campus page), those would further harden the signals.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - CDA presents itself as a Christian, Classical, Collaborative school with a mission to train virtuous, wise individuals to shape culture for the glory of God, linking character formation to a theological frame. This is stated on the About page and mission statements. - The site references theology woven into academics, Bible curricula, chapel gatherings, and biblical worldview framing. - Distinctives explicitly affirm Christian foundations (Nicene Creed), and a Christ-centered, biblical approach per campus materials. - The “pursue truth, goodness, and beauty” phrasing anchors transcendental aims within a theological framework.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christian, Christ-centered, biblical worldview/theology, Bible/chapel, Nicene Creed, presence of God, sacred/traditional vocabulary, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, liturgical/topical worship language. - According to the Six Essential Elements lexicon, these map to Positive Indicators like theology, liturgy/worship, reverence, wonder, and transcendental truthed values. See the Positive Keyword lists (e.g., “Theology,” “Liturgical and Communal Practices,” “Pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty”).

Why this rating - The school grounds its entire mission in a Christian metaphysical vision and weaves theological commitments into the curricular and communal life. In the Six Elements framework, this hits the core signals for True/Good/Beautiful, theocentric formation, and liturgical community life. The absence of explicit secular relocation signals strengthens the CLASSICAL designation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - CDA's mission is to “train ethical servant leaders and wise thinkers who will shape culture for the glory of God,” signaling formation-focused aims rather than merely job-prep. - The “Collaborative University Schedule” frames formation of character and spiritual/trust-based formation, aligning with formation over information. - Statements about pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty, and preparing students to think critically and communicate with wisdom, reinforce the telos of classical formation.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, formation, human flourishing, wisdom, contemplative learning, moral imagination, love of learning, intellectual virtue, mentorship, character formation, sacred/traditional language, logos/metaphysical ordering, teleology, and the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty. - The Six Elements Positive Keywords include items like “formation,” “pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty,” “great conversation,” and “moral imagination.” CDA's materials exhibit these signals. See the Six Elements lexicon and examples cited.

Why this rating - CDA centers formation over mere information, emphasizes virtue and wisdom as the telos of education, and anchors education in a theological vision that aligns with classical aims described in the Six Elements. There are no clear counter-signals in the public materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is framed as liberal-arts oriented with grammar, logic, and rhetoric as foundational, and it includes Latin instruction beginning in third grade. Evidence of grammar/logic/rhetoric, and Latin is explicit on site materials. - The school emphasizes “great works” and engagement with history, literature, and art as central to learning, aligned with classical education. - The public materials reference an integrated curriculum anchored in Western/Christian tradition and a historically informed approach to history and literature, consistent with Great Books/Great Conversation signals.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive signals include: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Quadrivium signals (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, history/literature integration, classical languages, pedagogy emphasizing wonder. - The Six Elements Positive Keywords include “grammar, logic, rhetoric,” “Great Books,” “Latin,” and “history in a Western-civilization frame.” CDA content aligns with these.

Why this rating - CDA's curriculum description and specific course scaffolding (Latin in grammar school, logic/rhetoric in later grades, engagement with history through a classical lens) align with classical curriculum expectations. There is no persistent evidence of a predominantly "social studies-first" or purely project-based approach in the public content; instead, the Great Books/liberal-arts framing is clear.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion and rhetoric training, with opportunities for speeches and debates. The Rhetoric School materials outline logic application, rhetoric, and public persuasion. - Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, memory work, and recitation to deepen memory and delight in learning (evident in various campus pages describing early-grade pedagogy, and discussions of family-lesson engagement). - The collaborative model integrates teacher-led instruction and at-home reinforcement, emphasizing a living curriculum where parents reinforce learning. This pedagogical model aligns with classical traditions of formation through memory, recital, and memory-work, as well as dialogic inquiry in higher grades. - Some pages explicitly describe "Socratic Dialogue" and "Growing in Wisdom," indicating a targeted use of the dialectic method in appropriate grade bands.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminar, recitation, narration, chanting, memory work, rhetoric, public speaking, seminars, debate, scholarly discourse, scholé (restful contemplation) signals, liturgical/chanting in memory work, and formation through contemplative practices. - The Six Elements Positive keywords include "Socratic dialogue," "great conversation," "narration/recitation," "memory work," "rhetoric, debate, oratory," and "scholé/restful learning." CDA materials match these signals.

Why this rating - CDA's pedagogy explicitly uses classical methods (Socratic dialogue in high school, rhetoric training, public speaking, memory/recitation in lower grades) and includes contemplative/restful elements (scholé-like orientation) in the program materials. This aligns with CLASSICAL pedagogy signals in the rubric.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as virtuous, knowledgeable, and living exemplars; teachers are framed as mentors who form the living curriculum and partners with families. The materials reference a "portrait of a teacher" and a faculty culture built on virtue and shared inquiry. - The community emphasizes faculty leadership, stewardship, and a collaborative culture, with college-level-level teacher collaboration highlighted in the "collaborative" model and leadership statements. - Statements emphasize that faculty/leadership model virtue, skill, and knowledge, and are central to the school's mission and culture.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtuous educators, mentor/guide, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core of school, collegial culture, mentorship, professional development, and shared inquiry. - The Six Elements Positive Keywords include "Teachers as Models of Virtue," "Mentorship and Collegiality," "Portrait of a Teacher," and "Living Curriculum." CDA content aligns with these signals.

Why this rating - The public materials present a cohesive vision of faculty as models of virtue and living curriculum, with a collaborative, mentorship-focused faculty culture. This supports a CLASSICAL designation for the Faculty category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Collaborative Model centers parent partnership with the school, describing parents as co-teachers who reinforce mastery at home and guide at-home learning with provided resources. - There is explicit emphasis on parent formation (gatherings, book studies, communications) and open-campus/home-learning integration; multiple pages describe parents as primary educators in partnership with CDA. - The community features stories of parent involvement, mentor families for new families, and a culture of home-school collaboration.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, home-school integration, classical family culture, parent formation, hospitality/open campus, family catechesis, lived tradition in the family. - The Six Elements Positive Keywords include “Partnership with Families,” “Formation of Affections,” “Cultural Transmission,” and “Parent partnership and home-school collaboration.” CDA content reflects these signals.

Why this rating - CDA presents a strongly partner-based, family-centric community model with explicit involvement of parents as co-educators and ongoing parent formation activities. This maps cleanly to CLASSICAL signals in the Parents & Community category.

Aggregate Assessment - All six categories are CLASSICAL based on the evidence and keyword signals present in the school’s public materials and the knowledge-base rubric. The school’s overall approach emphasizes a Christian, Classical, collaborative model, with liberal-arts curricula, Socratic/rhetorical pedagogy, a living-faculty mission, and robust parent partnership.

What Would Move the Needle - If seeking to strengthen the CLASSICAL signal even further, CDA could consistently foreground the exact “Great Books” framing in every campus/program page (beyond references to “great works” and the classical curriculum) and uniform use of classical terminology (e.g., explicit “Great Books,” “Great Conversation” labels) across all campus sites. This would reduce any ambiguity and further align with the lexicon of the Six Essential Elements documents. Additionally, a short, campus-wide codified statement of liturgical practices (chapel cadence, liturgical calendar, and sacred-music norms) could more explicitly satisfy Liturgical and Communal Practices signals.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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